

Judge temporarily stops border construction in Texas' Big Bend region

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A federal judge has **temporarily** stopped border wall construction and related projects in Texas' Big Bend region. The decision includes Big Bend National Park, known for its landscapes, limestone cliffs and clear views of the night sky.

Judge Kathleen Cardone issued the **ruling** on Friday. It covers a border region about 500 miles long. The pause gives the court time to consider a **lawsuit**. It is not a final decision about whether the projects can go ahead.

An environmental organization, supporters of a historic church and a river guide brought the case. They argue that the Department of Homeland Security wrongly set aside rules protecting nature, cultural places and archaeological sites. **Archaeology** is the study of past people through objects and places they left behind.

The construction plans are part of the Trump administration's wider border project. Landowners, businesses and environmental groups have opposed work in Big Bend. Republicans and Democrats also objected after land clearing began inside the park in August.

The administration says it is reviewing plans for the national park. Federal agencies did not immediately answer requests for comment on Friday's **ruling**.

Park **advocates** welcomed the pause. They asked officials to repair damage already done and discuss other plans with local residents.

Word Treasure

temporarily -- For a limited time.

ruling -- A decision made by a court.

lawsuit -- A dispute brought to a court for a decision.

Archaeology -- The study of past people through objects and places they left behind.

advocates -- People who speak up in support of something.

Background you need

Archaeology studies past people through the objects and places they left behind.

The construction pause is temporary; the court has not made a final decision about the projects.

Break it down

Introduces the construction pause and the national park.

Explains the ruling's size and temporary status.

Identifies the lawsuit's participants and their argument.

Describes opposition and the administration's review.

Ends with park advocates' requests.

Why it matters

The ruling affects construction in a national park and the surrounding region. The case concerns rules meant to protect nature and cultural places.

Test what you remember

1. What did the judge temporarily stop in Big Bend?
 - (A) Business openings and local markets
 - (B) Border wall construction and related projects
 - (C) Church repairs and historical research
 - (D) Park visits and guided walking tours
2. About how long is the border region covered by the ruling?
 - (A) About 1,000 miles
 - (B) About 100 miles
 - (C) About 250 miles
 - (D) About 500 miles
3. What does the article say about the court's decision?
 - (A) It permanently ends the border projects.
 - (B) It gives time to consider the lawsuit.
 - (C) It approves construction throughout the park.
 - (D) It settles every claim in the case.
4. Who brought the lawsuit?
 - (A) An environmental group, church supporters and a river guide
 - (B) Federal agencies, researchers and local officials
 - (C) Businesses, road builders and park guides
 - (D) Landowners, park visitors and local teachers
5. What do the people bringing the case argue?
 - (A) Officials wrongly limited visits to churches.
 - (B) Officials wrongly set aside protective rules.
 - (C) Officials wrongly closed local public schools.
 - (D) Officials wrongly canceled night sky tours.
6. What did park advocates ask officials to do?
 - (A) Build roads and expand nearby businesses
 - (B) Close trails and stop meetings with residents
 - (C) Repair damage and discuss other plans
 - (D) Expand parking and add more park tours

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: B 4: A 5: B 6: C

Questions to think about

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):